RADIO INTERVIEW PREP

Deepfakes, Girls, and Digital Safety

Naiyarah Hussain · AI Safety UAE · On air 02:30pm

SPEAKER BIO

Naiyarah Hussain is an ML Engineer, a national coding ambassador for the UAE under the Ministry of AI, and co-founder of AI Safety UAE, a community that brings together technologists, legal experts, and civil society to tackle the country's most critical AI safety challenges, in line with the UAE's national AI strategy.

Her technical research focuses on how AI systems can produce false or misleading outputs, in healthcare, in media, and increasingly, in everyday life. That work sits at the heart of today's conversation, because AI fake videos are one of the most visible and damaging ways AI is being used to deceive people right now.

KEY TALKING POINTS

01 What is a Deepfake / *Start simple. Most listeners are parents, not engineers.*

Don't assume listeners know the difference. Give them the mental model first.

Most people have heard the word deepfake. Fewer know what it actually means or how close to home it already is.

A deepfake uses your face, your voice, or your body. Real people, made to appear doing or saying things they never did. That is different from a general AI fake video, which could be anything. **A deepfake is always personal. It uses someone's identity without their consent.**

The technology used to require a research lab and months of work. Today it takes a free app and five minutes.

And the people being targeted most are women and girls.

02 Why Women and Girls / *Democratized Access, Zero Guardrails*

Emotional core of the segment. Do not rush it..

Deepfakes are being used against women and girls in three specific ways.

Non-consensual intimate imagery. A real woman's face placed onto explicit content she had no knowledge of and gave no consent to. It gets shared. Sometimes sold. The damage to her reputation, her mental health, her safety, is immediate and very hard to undo.

Blackmail. Someone creates a deepfake, then threatens to distribute it unless she pays money, provides more images, or does what they demand. We are seeing this used against schoolgirls, against professionals, against public figures.

Harassment and silencing. Sometimes the goal is not money. It is to make a woman feel so exposed and unsafe that she disappears from public life entirely. **We are watching women make themselves smaller, stop posting, or go offline completely because of this.**

Bollywood actor Soha Ali Khan, also a UNFPA advocate, spoke publicly about her own experience at India AI Impact Summit. She said she had no control over her face, her image, her body. Even with her platform and her resources, she could not get real recourse. **If someone with her privilege cannot get help, what does that say about everyone else?**

I also know of a young influencer in India, a friend's cousin, whose photos were deepfaked and circulated without her knowledge. Her accounts were hacked. She filed a police report. She contacted India's cyber police. She ended up deleting her entire Instagram and TikTok.She will not speak publicly about it because **the fear and the shame do not go away just because you reported it.**

03 The Scale/ *Relevant Right Now*

Read these numbers slowly. Pause between them.

In 2010, there were approximately 100,000 reports of child sexual abuse material globally.

By 2023, **that number was 36.2 million.**

Not 36 percent more. **360 times more. In thirteen years.**

Lt Col Dana Humaid Al Marzooqi of the UAE said it plainly: the scale is staggering. And AI is now accelerating the production of this material, because it allows perpetrators to generate it without ever physically accessing a child.

Child Sexual Exploitation Material is the number one AI safety issue affecting children right now. It is not a future concern. It is happening today.

X and Grok have both faced investigations over AI-generated child sexual abuse material being produced and circulated on their platforms. **These are not niche platforms. These are mainstream tools we use everyday.**

04 What To Do If This Happens to You or Your Child / *Practical: Give Listeners Something to Leave With*

Radio listeners can't screenshot a list. Give them 3 things maximum and make them memorable.

One. Document before you report. Screenshot, save the URL, note the date and platform. Content disappears fast and you may need evidence.

Two. Report to the platform. Every major platform has a reporting process for non-consensual intimate imagery. Use it and keep records of everything you send.

Three. In the UAE, you have real legal protection. Federal Decree-Law No. 34 of 2021 covers the creation and distribution of content that violates personal privacy. You can report to the UAE Cybercrime unit at cybercrime.gov.ae.

And just last year, the UAE passed **Federal Decree by Law No. 26 of 2025 on Child Digital Safety**, which holds platforms directly accountable for protecting children online. This is a strong law in the Year of Family.

At AI Safety UAE, we are building practical checklists for different audiences: policymakers, international organisations, parents, caregivers, and communities, to make it straightforward to

know what this law requires of them and how to act on it. **You should not need a lawyer to understand your rights or your responsibilities.**

Gulf News has a practical guide for UAE residents on protecting yourself from AI image misuse. We will share the link after the show.

05 What Needs to Change / *Call to Action*

Connect the technical to the everyday.

Reporting after the fact is not enough.

Professor Rachel Thomas, a professor on data ethics, put it this way: **the people most affected must have avenues for participation and power.** Children and families need to be part of designing these systems, not consulted as an afterthought.

Three things need to happen:

Safety by design, privacy by default. When a minor opens a social media account, it should be private from the start. Digital safety should not be buried in terms and conditions nobody reads.

Meaningful consent and real incident reporting. When something goes wrong, families need to know who to call, in a language they understand, and they need a response in hours, not months.

Enforced standards, not voluntary pledges. The UAE has shown with the Federal Decree on Child Digital Safety that governments can act. Other countries need to follow. ISO standards for AI management exist. They should be a prerequisite of doing business.

At AI Safety UAE, we are building this infrastructure. Digital safety protocols for women and children, education programmes, policy checklists, and working groups under the UAE Year of the Family. **If you are a parent, a teacher, a school counsellor, or someone who cares about this, we want you involved.**

This conversation cannot stay inside technical circles. **It has to reach families. That is what today is about.**

QUICK REFERENCE | LINKS FOR PRODUCER AND SHOW NOTES

→ **AI Safety UAE:** aisafety.ae
→ **Federal Decree on Child Digital Safety:** uaelegislation.gov.ae/en/legislations/3912/download
→ **Gulf News guide for UAE resident:** gulfnews.com/technology/your-photos-arent-safe-how-uae-residents-can-protect-themselves-from-ai-image-misuse-1.500405881
→ **No More: How AI Chatbots Are Reshaping Violence Against Women and Girls:** bit.ly/4sSP6Nu

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